Printing and assembly

Print single-sided on US Letter at 100% / Actual size. The action-track page is landscape; enable automatic page rotation, never Fit to page. Both multirow 3-inch-section tracks are on one sheet. Use the six-slot track for 2 players and the eight-slot track for 3-4 players sharing two factions. The top RAP decrease from 3 to 2 is intentional.

Cut card outlines. Hero and tactic cards are 2.5 x 3.5 inches; compact queue portraits are 1.25 x 1.75 inches and fit either track. Put faction/element badges below the portraits after random assignment; mark standee bases with the same element. Use separate hero cards for damage, status and equipment.

Print all 36 tactics once. Remove the nine cards of the commonly omitted element for 2-player games, leaving 27 in one shared deck. Sleeve cards with opaque backs; do not print the old duplex deck. Six objectives form one shared finite deck. Fold ten hero standees along the dotted center, using the blank foot area for stands. Supply three Recruit pieces per faction, extras if purchased, red damage cubes, two VP markers and dice.

Trim and join the two map halves along their center seam without scaling. Mount four trap and five starting Moonstone tokens onto the nine identical backs; shuffle and reveal at setup. Remaining Moonstones are the reserve. Print extra tokens if required.

Preparation details

Choose three heroes with 15 PP per faction, or four with 20 PP for 3-4 players (TEST). Three free Recruits per faction. Partners share control, resources, hand and faction turn. Secretly select a zone and bid PP; contested zone goes to the higher bidder, who takes first turn and pays the bid as compensation to the opponent. Rebid tied contested choices. Different zones: random first player. Lower bidder owns the highest queue slot, then alternate owners; with equal ignored bids the second faction owns the top (TEST). Randomly place each faction's heroes in its assigned slots.

Buy before drawing: extra Recruit 3 PP; group Boots 2 PP, Shields 3 PP, Weapons 3 PP, each once. One equipment per hero and one copy per faction; retain through respawn. Extra starting tactic 1 PP, up to the hand limit. Unspent ordinary PP expires; only unused bid compensation pays attacker rerolls.

Each hero action has a separate increasing cost: Move, Attack, Grab, Respawn each cost 1, then 2, then 3 AP per repeat. Each Recruit instead shares one increasing counter across all paid actions. Counters reset on the next friendly turn, never on respawn. Paid abilities have their own repeat counter starting at printed AP; card-only abilities stay card-only. Ability/tactic movement and free Recruit assault attacks do not advance paid counters.

Icon key

Heart: HP. Pale hex: Move or distance. Blue shield: Defense. Sword / bow: melee / ranged Attack. Focus adds attack dice; Enraged adds hit damage; Fortified adds defense dice; Dazed subtracts defense dice; Poison ticks at own-turn start. AP is usable by the active hero or Recruits; RAP is Recruit-only. PP buys preparation items; RP is campaign currency; VP measures victory. Ability markers are separate from the five statuses. Starter heroes have no regional ability.

Moonfall Tactics — Rules Quick Sheet

shared-elements-v15 design update · 30 October 2026 · TEST defaults are adjustable. Full rules and lore are in the main Design Draft tab; hero-specific wording is in the live Moonfall Tactics sheet.

Setup and turn

Prepare: 15 PP; choose three heroes and three free Recruits. Team 4v4 TEST: 20 PP and four heroes per faction. Bid secretly for deployment; higher bid wins a contested zone/first turn and compensates the opponent. Only unused compensation survives as attacker reroll PP.

Fire (red flame), Water (turquoise droplet), Earth (brown rock), and Wind (sky-blue gust). Both factions use the same elements. Display element color/symbol together with faction color/insignia as a two-color identity code. For 1v1, choose one element to omit for both sides and use the same three active elements; four-hero games use all four. After

roster lock, independently shuffle the active elements with state RNG and assign one to each hero on each side. Players cannot choose or swap assignments. Match map piece, queue holder and hero card.

Deploy: living models occupy full empty hexes in their zone or nearest legal overflow. Both factions share one 27-card deck (36 with all four elements); draw 2 tactics, limit 8. Draw one hidden objective, limit 2.

Turn start: scenario VP, immediate victory, then each friendly poisoned unit takes 1 damage/removes 1 Poison. Choose any friendly hero, capture AP/RAP, shift its queue card to bottom; remove its ongoing ability tokens.

Queue AP/RAP bottom□top: 3v3 — 1/1, 2/1, 3/1, 3/2, 4/3, 5/2. 4v4 TEST — 1/1, 2/1, 2/2, 3/1, 3/2, 4/2, 4/3, 5/2. No queue draws.

Actions: heroes may Move, Attack, Grab or Respawn; Recruits may Move, Attack or Respawn. AP pays for active hero or friendly Recruits; RAP only Recruits (spend first). Each hero action independently costs 1/2/3…; each Recruit shares one 1/2/3… counter. Respawn fully heals/clears statuses, but never resets costs. Ability/tactic movement costs no extra action.

Abilities: discard a tactic matching the hero's assigned element, plus printed AP. Generic rainbow ? means that element. Card-only repeats need another card, no AP. Ongoing effects require an ability token after payment; expire at next own activation start or defeat.

Combat and statuses

Roll: defender/attacker alternate tactics or pass; two passes roll. Compare highest face, then six counts only if both highest are 6; attacker wins remaining ties. Zero pool rolls two D6 and keeps only lower. Attacker rerolls own dice for 1 PP each from bid compensation; resolve automatically when no reroll or card play is legal; otherwise finish explicitly.

Hit: 1 damage + each kept attacker six + Enraged + Heavy Attack(x) + declared damage bonuses, capped last by Light Attack(x). Winning defense gains one Focus per kept six. No reward from losing-side sixes.

Modifiers: melee +1 Attack die per other adjacent ally with no other adjacent enemy. Ranged −2 if any enemy adjacent, and −2 beyond range to double range; stack both. Exact ranges never extend. Nothing blocks sight.

Focus / Enraged: next attack gets +1 die / +1 hit damage per token; spend complete participating stacks after attack, even on miss. Fortified / Dazed: +1 / −1 Defense die per token, spend both participating stacks after defense. New after-effect tokens survive.

Poison: on-hit Poison(x) adds x; own-turn tick deals 1/removes 1. Heal restores HP AND clears all Poison, even at full HP. Hero damage from above 1 HP to exactly 1 gives 1 Enraged, each time, including after healing.

Movement keywords: follow the scenario's terrain rules. Push/Pull moves strictly away/toward fixed source by one each step, obeying occupancy/full hexes and hazards, stopping on defeat. Fly ignores intervening units/terrain, destination still legal/hazardous.

Tactics, rewards and victory

Card use: printed tactic effect OR matching-element ability payment. During combat, Cancel answers only the opponent's immediately preceding tactic and can cancel Cancel. Playing another boost gives up the earlier cancellation opportunity. Ability payments and out-of-combat tactics do not interrupt the inactive player. Paid cards stay spent. Counterattack triggers on a miss, ordinary range/responses, optional, no chains.

Deck: each element has two +2 Attack, two +2 hit damage, one Cancel, +2 Defense, counterattack-on-miss, Move 4 hex/heal 1 and Recruit assault. Printed effects require no element match. Reshuffle the shared discard; no automatic empty-hand draw.

End: automatically collect stones beneath living friendly heroes (never Recruits) and resolve overflow; claim at most one eligible objective for 1 VP + 1 tactic; draw an objective only if hand empty/deck nonempty; resolve authored end effect/fire; apply scenario end-turn effects; pass. Immediately stop if any VP award reaches victory.

Objectives: follow the condition printed on your card. Only held, eligible objectives count; eligibility begins on your next own turn. Claim at most one at turn end for 1 VP + 1 tactic. The finite six-card objective deck never reshuffles.

Moonstone: only heroes collect; Recruits cannot collect by any method. Each pickup draws one tactic and grants the collecting hero 1 Focus; each secured stone pays 2 RP at settlement. Hero defeat drops one stone, draws one tactic for

owner and moves its card to bottom. Recruit defeat does neither. Secured stones never drop again.

Moonfall Tactics — Scenarios

Three Fires

Each scenario uses a map plus its own deployment/spawning edges, special rules, VP sources and victory threshold or explicit VP payout. A map can support multiple scenarios and multiple group spawning edges; scenario rules specify which are active. No map-specific victory condition is inferred from artwork.

Three Fires: water/north scores 1 VP at the start of each of its own turns, regardless of bonfire control. Stone/south scores 1 VP PER bonfire it controls at the start of each of its own turns. Control means more adjacent friendly units than enemy units; ties are uncontrolled. First to 15 VP wins; check immediately after every award. 1 VP per enemy defeat and no friendly-fire VP.

Random setup: every map has nine X locations. For this map shuffle four traps and five Moonstone tokens with identical backs face down onto the Xs, then reveal all before play. The boxed reference identifies positions only; print the original map without boxes.

Any movement into a trap deals 1 damage, then removes it. Any movement into fire deals 1 damage; ending a character's turn there also deals 1 damage. Resolve each entry separately, including voluntary and forced movement, stopping if defeated. Fire hexes are enterable. TEST recruit timing: fire end-turn damage applies to recruits that acted during that friendly turn. Moving an idle hero by an ability is not itself ending its activation.

Deployment: use the chosen north blue or south stone zone. Every full hex in that zone is eligible if otherwise legal; a few pixels of map alignment error are acceptable. Half hexes are never eligible. If the zone is full, use the nearest legal empty overflow hex.

Battlefield modifiers

After the first scenario, roll a d6 once at scenario setup, after revealing traps and Moonstones. The result lasts for that scenario. Modifier rules belong with the scenario, not in the Rules Quick Sheet.

1 Plague: at faction turn end, each living unit adjacent to at least one poisoned living unit gains 1 Poison. Snapshot sources first; no cascade. TEST timing.

2 Wind: roll one fixed axial direction at setup. Each friendly unit may take one optional free 1 hex step that direction per own turn; normal occupancy and entry hazards apply.

3 Storm: ranged attacks have –1 Attack die.

4 Snow: ordinary Move allowance is reduced by 1 hex, minimum zero; fixed ability/tactic movement is unchanged (TEST).

5 Heat: gaining Enraged from zero adds exactly 1 extra; no recursion.

6 Moonfall: at setup add one Moonstone to a random legal full adjacent hex per trap; stones may stack.

Campaign (TEST)

Each secured Moonstone pays 2 RP at settlement; baseline 10 RP and winner +1 RP. Campaign ends at ten wins or a four-win lead. Regional recruitment, travel and catch-up income remain unfinished; this kit supplies the starter scenario, not a complete campaign.